

efit from product demonstrations. A gaming show can use gameplay, while an educational show may need diagrams or screen recordings.

Use this test:

- **Step 1:** Write down how your ideal listener currently consumes your show.
- **Step 2:** List three moments in a typical episode where seeing something would improve understanding or enjoyment.
- **Step 3:** Decide whether full-length video is necessary or whether short promotional clips provide most of the benefit.
- **Step 4:** Estimate the additional recording, editing, storage and upload work.
- **Step 5:** Add video only if the value justifies the burden.

Spotify itself suggests that creators who are not recording complete video episodes can use short video clips to experiment with the format first.

Start with the camera you already own

A recent smartphone is usually the sensible first video-podcast camera. It records high-resolution footage, is easy to operate and may already outperform a cheap webcam.

Mount it on a tripod, clean the lens, connect power for long sessions and check available storage. If the phone allows manual control, lock exposure and white balance so the image does not visibly brighten, darken or change colour whenever somebody moves.

Frame the full episode in landscape orientation. A 16:9 composition works naturally with long-form video services; Spotify recommends 16:9 for uploaded video podcast episodes, while YouTube says 16:9 is the most commonly used aspect ratio for video players and previews.

If you need vertical clips, crop them from the landscape master or record a separate vertical camera. Do not shoot an entire interview vertically simply because you plan to produce Shorts later.

Frame people, not furniture

Beginners often put the camera too far away because they want to show the whole studio. Viewers usually care more about faces.

For a solo presenter, start with a medium close-up: roughly chest or shoulders upward, with a little space above the head. For two people, frame both in one wide shot or use separate angles.

Keep the camera near eye level. Leave enough space around the subject for slight cropping during editing. If the host speaks directly to the audience, look into the lens. During an interview, look primarily at the guest; natural conversation matters more than constant lens contact.

One camera is enough (to begin)

A single-camera video podcast can look professional if framing, lighting and audio are good.

For two speakers, place the camera far enough back to include both comfortably. Record in 4K if your device, storage and editing



computer can handle it. The extra resolution may allow you to crop a 1080p final video into host and guest close-ups.

Try this pseudo-multicam workflow:

- **Step 1:** Record a stable wide shot containing one or both speakers.
- **Step 2:** Place the footage on a 1080p editing timeline.
- **Step 3:** Duplicate the clip onto additional tracks.
- **Step 4:** Crop one version around the host and another around the guest.
- **Step 5:** Cut between the wide shot and close-ups according to whoever is speaking.

Do not crop so aggressively that image quality becomes visibly soft.

Moving to two or three cameras

A true multicamera setup gives you more flexibility. A typical two-person arrangement uses one wide camera showing both speakers, one close-up of the host and one close-up of the guest.

If your budget allows two cameras, use one wide plus one tighter angle, or two individual close-ups with an occasional split-screen layout.

Match camera settings. Different frame rates, white balance and exposure can make cuts jarring.

Before recording:

- **Step 1:** Set every camera to the same frame rate and compatible resolution.
- **Step 2:** Lock white balance where possible.
- **Step 3:** Match exposure by checking skin tones.
- **Step 4:** Start all cameras before the conversation begins.
- **Step 5:** Clap once while every camera and audio recorder is running.

The clap creates a visible and audible sync point. Many editors can also synchronise clips automatically from recorded audio, but the clap remains useful when automation fails.

Record remote video guests carefully

Remote video adds another failure point because each guest controls their own camera, lighting and internet connection. Send a